공식 자료 보관본 · 2026-10-21
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1.3 MySQL Releases: Innovation and LTS

The MySQL release model is divided into two main tracks: LTS (Long-Term Support) and Innovation. All LTS and Innovation releases include bug and security fixes, and are considered production-grade quality.

MySQL Version Numbers

MySQL 9.7 is the final release line using the previous sequential versioning model. Subsequent MySQL Innovation and LTS releases use calendar versioning in the YY.M format, where YY represents the year and M represents the scheduled release month.

For example, MySQL 26.7 represents the July 2026 release, and MySQL 27.7 represents the July 2027 release. When a release is designated as an LTS release, its YY.M version remains fixed throughout the support lifecycle of that LTS series.

MySQL LTS Releases

- `Audience`: If your environment requires a stable set of features and a longer support period.
- `Behavior`: These releases only contain necessary fixes to reduce the risks associated with changes in the database software's behavior. There are no removals within an LTS release. Features can be removed (and added) only in the first LTS release (such as 8.4.0 LTS) but not later.
- `Support`: An LTS series follows the Oracle Lifetime Support Policy, which includes 5 years of premier support and 3 years of extended support.

MySQL Innovation Releases

- `Audience`: If you want access to the latest features, improvements, and changes. These releases are ideal for developers and DBAs working in fast-paced development environments with high levels of automated tests and modern continuous integration techniques for faster upgrade cycles.
- `Behavior`: Apart from new features in innovation releases, behavior changes are also expected as code is refactored, deprecated functionality is removed, and when MySQL is modified to behave more in line with SQL Standards. This will not happen within an LTS release.

  Behavior changes can have a big impact, especially when dealing with anything application-related, such as SQL syntax, new reserved words, query execution, and query performance. Behavior changes might require application changes which can involve considerable effort to migrate. We intend to provide the necessary tools and configuration settings to make these transitions easier.
- `Support`: Innovation releases are supported until the next Innovation release.

MySQL Portfolio

MySQL Server and MySQL NDB Cluster have both Innovation and LTS releases.

MySQL Connectors, MySQL Shell, MySQL Router, MySQL Operator for Kubernetes, have one release using the latest version number but remain compatible with all supported MySQL Server versions. For example, MySQL Connector/Python 9.7.0 is compatible with supported MySQL Server 8.0, 8.4, and 9.x releases.

When a major version line advances (for example, 26.7), these products will follow the new major version while continuing to support the then-current Innovation and LTS releases of MySQL Server and MySQL NDB Cluster.

Installing, Upgrading, and Downgrading

Having two tracks affects how MySQL is installed, upgraded, and downgraded. Typically you choose one particular track and all upgrades progress accordingly.

When using the official MySQL repository, the desired track is defined in the repository configuration. For example, with Yum choose `mysql-innovation-community` to install and upgrade Innovation releases or `mysql-9.7-lts-community` to install and upgrade MySQL 9.7.x releases.

LTS Notes

Functionality remains the same and data format does not change in an LTS series, therefore in-place upgrades and downgrades are possible within the LTS series. For example, MySQL 8.4.0 can be upgraded to a later MySQL 8.4.x release. Additional upgrade and downgrade methods are available, such as the clone plugin.

Upgrading to the next LTS series is supported, such as 8.4.x LTS to 9.7.x LTS, while skipping an LTS series is not supported. For example, you cannot skip from 8.4.x LTS directly to 28.4.x LTS.

Innovation Notes

An Innovation installation follows similar behavior in that an Innovation release upgrades to a more recent Innovation series release. For example, MySQL 9.1.0 Innovation would upgrade to MySQL 9.2.0.

The main difference is that you cannot directly upgrade between an Innovation series of different major versions, such as 8.3.0 to 9.0.0. Instead, first upgrade to the nearest LTS series and then upgrade to the following Innovation series. For example, upgrading 8.3.0 to 8.4.0, and then 8.4.0 to 9.0.0, is a valid upgrade path.

To help make the transition easier, the official MySQL repository treats the first LTS release as both LTS and Innovation, so for example with the Innovation track enabled in your local repository configuration, MySQL 8.3.0 upgrades to 8.4.0, and later to 9.0.0.

Innovation release downgrades require a logical dump and load.

Additional Information and Examples

For additional information and specific example supported scenarios, see Section 3.2, “Upgrade Paths” or Chapter 4, *Downgrading MySQL*. They describe available options to perform in-place updates (that replace binaries with the latest packages), a logical dump and load (such as using **mysqldump** or MySQL Shell's dump utilities), cloning data with the clone plugin, and asynchronous replication for servers in a replication topology.

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